Critical Capabilities for Managed Network Services

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Initiatives:I&O Operations Management

Organizations rely on managed network services to support and secure their wide-area and local-area networks. However, service quality varies widely among providers. This research helps I&O leaders determine which provider best aligns with their service needs.

This Critical Capabilities is related to other research:

Magic Quadrant for Managed Network Services

View All Magic Quadrants and Critical Capabilities

Overview

Key Findings

- The managed network services (MNS) market is fragmented and large. Players in the market include traditional network service providers, systems integrators and pure-play MNS providers that differ greatly in terms of size, capability and geographic reach.
- MNS providers are adopting automation and artificial intelligence (AI) technologies to take over routine tasks from human engineers. MNS providers with greater automation and AI integration tend to offer more responsive, higher-quality services.
- Competitors in this market have upgraded their customer portals to offer improved network visibility, incident management and customer account support. There is a strong correlation between better customer portals and better service.
- Managed security is becoming pervasive across LAN and WAN environments, with a focus on zero-trust network access and by extension secure access service edge (SASE) product offerings.

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Recommendations

Infrastructure and operations (I&O) leaders evaluating and selecting managed network service providers should:

- Compare service delivery and support levels across providers by seeking competitive RFPs from a shortlist of no more than five providers. These can include some combination of network service providers (NSPs), pure-play network management providers and systems integrators, and other nontraditional providers.
- Focus assessments on key MNS elements to simplify provider comparisons. Key elements can include ease of service onboarding, network visibility, incident and change management response times, automation and AI enhancements, user experience, availability of service analytics, and any additional charges a vendor adds to the proposal.
- Require security as a mandatory element for all MNS RFPs based on the organization's specific needs. For example, if a higher level of protection from cyberattacks is required, the MNS RFP should require threat intelligence, incident response and security operations center (SOC) services.
- Request and assess candidate MNS providers' service-level agreements (SLAs) to guarantee faster incident response times, higher monitored equipment availability and service credits for SLA violations.

Strategic Planning Assumptions

- By 2026, generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) technology will account for 20% of initial network configuration, which is an increase from near zero in 2023.
- By 2027, 65% of new software-defined wide-area network (SD-WAN) purchases will be part of a single-vendor SASE offering, an increase from 20% in 2024.

What You Need to Know

The MNS market focuses on externally provided, network operations center (NOC) functionality, as well as relevant network and security life cycle services that deliver current and emerging requirements to end users. Capabilities that we analyze in this research include providers' service delivery platforms, service management, operations automation and customer experience management, as well as their LAN, WAN and security service management.

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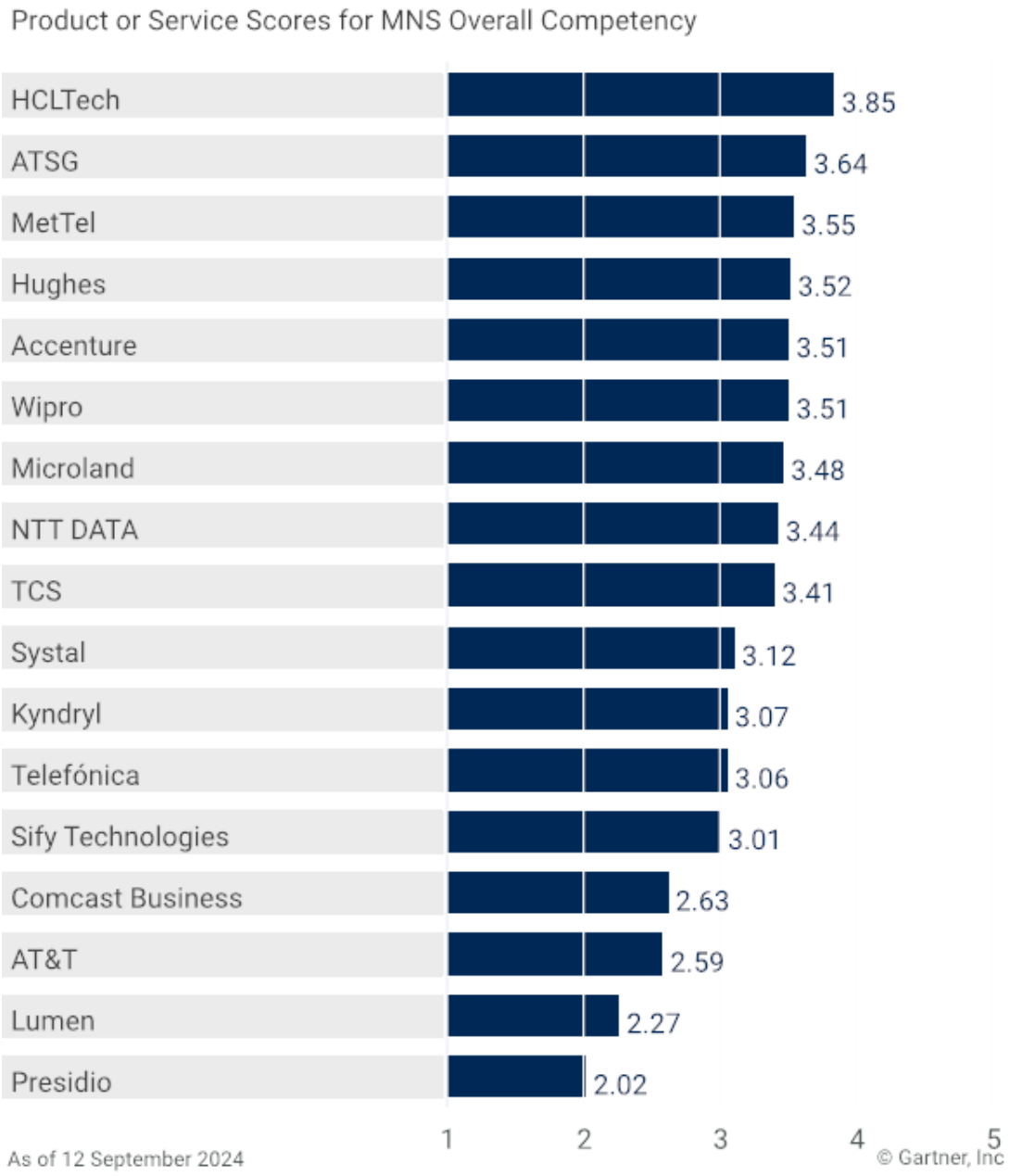
Analysis

Critical Capabilities Use-Case Graphics

Vendors' Product Scores for MNS Overall Competency Use Case



Gartner

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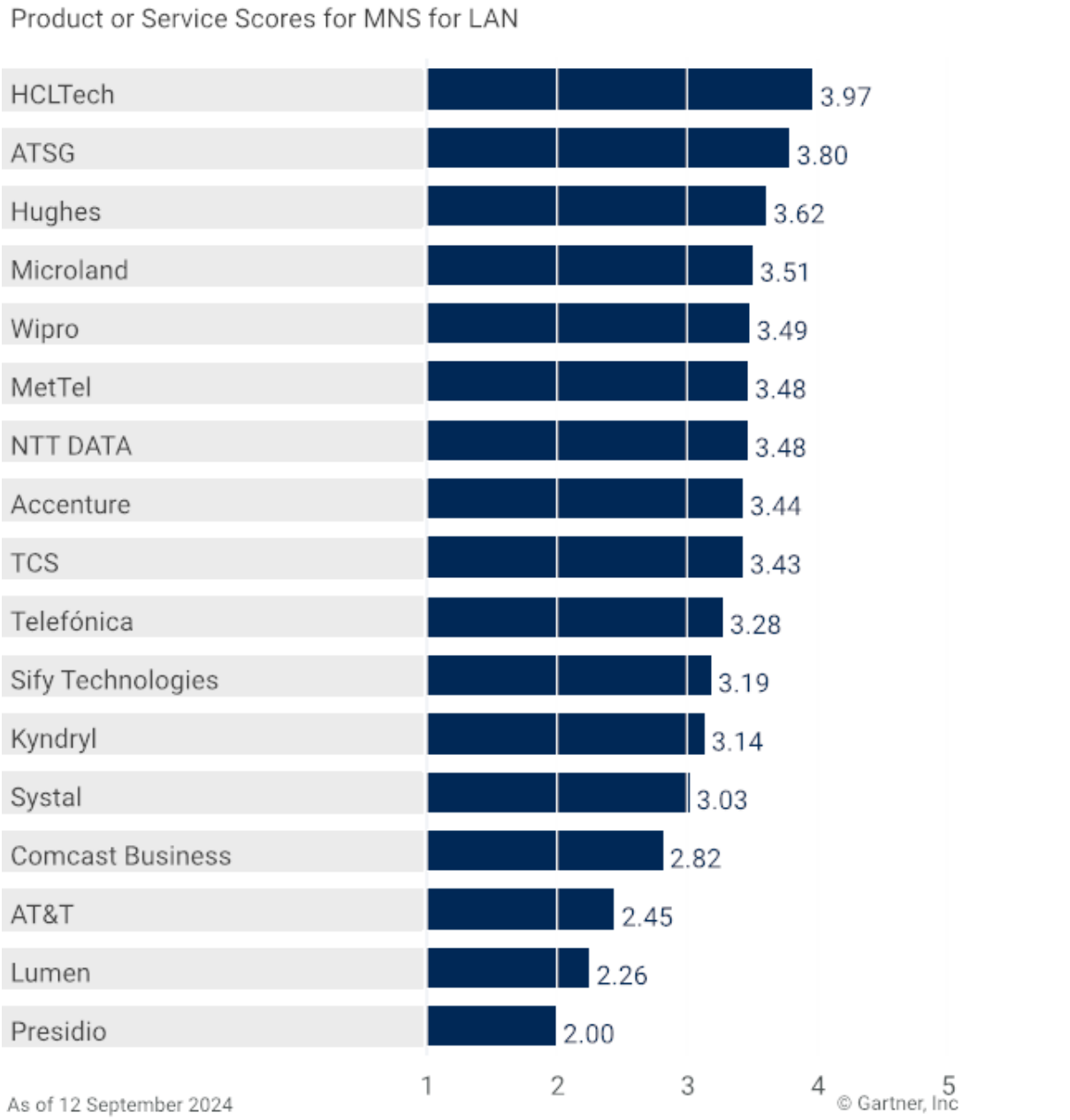
Vendors' Product Scores for MNS for LAN Use Case



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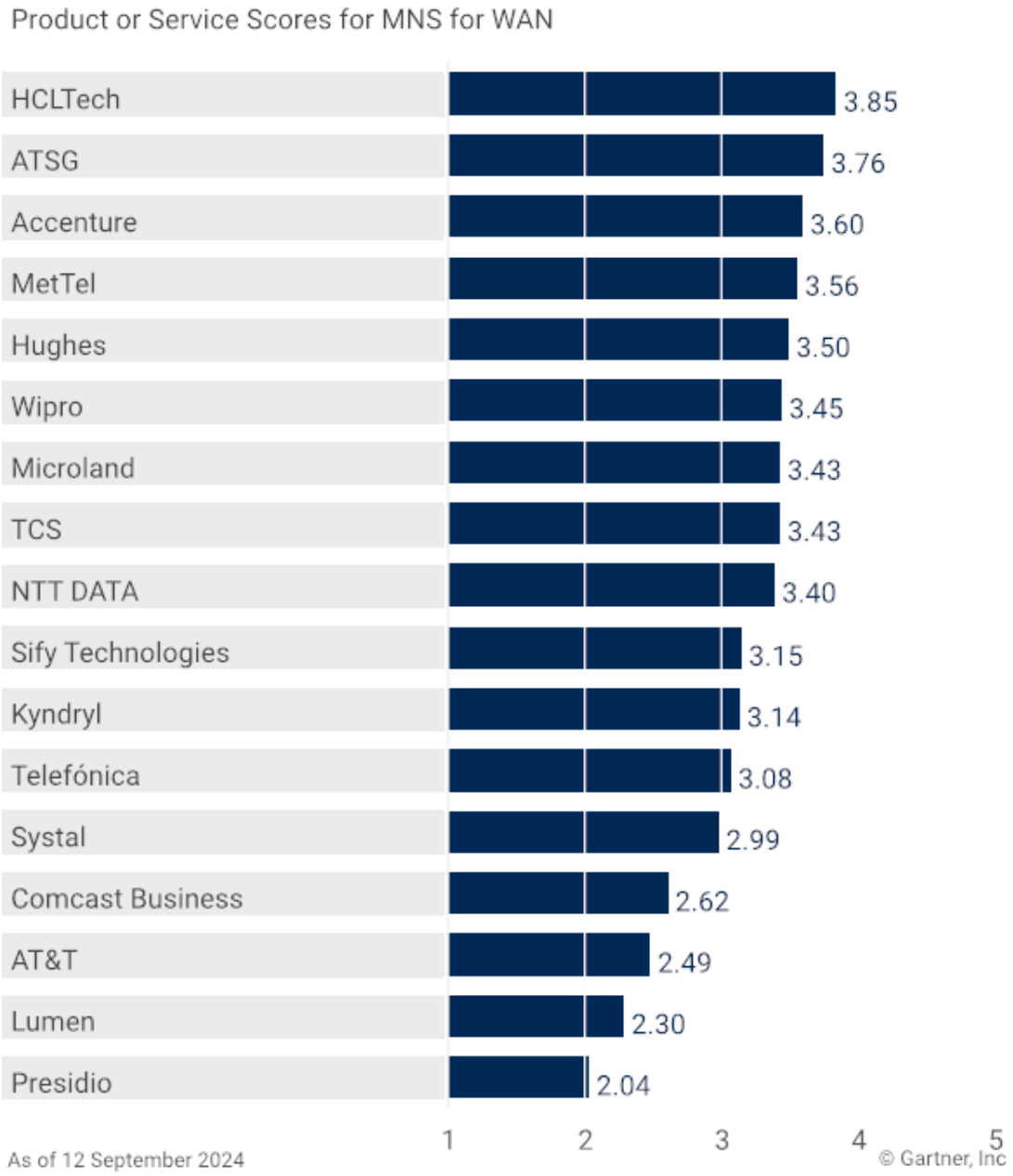
Vendors' Product Scores for MNS for WAN Use Case



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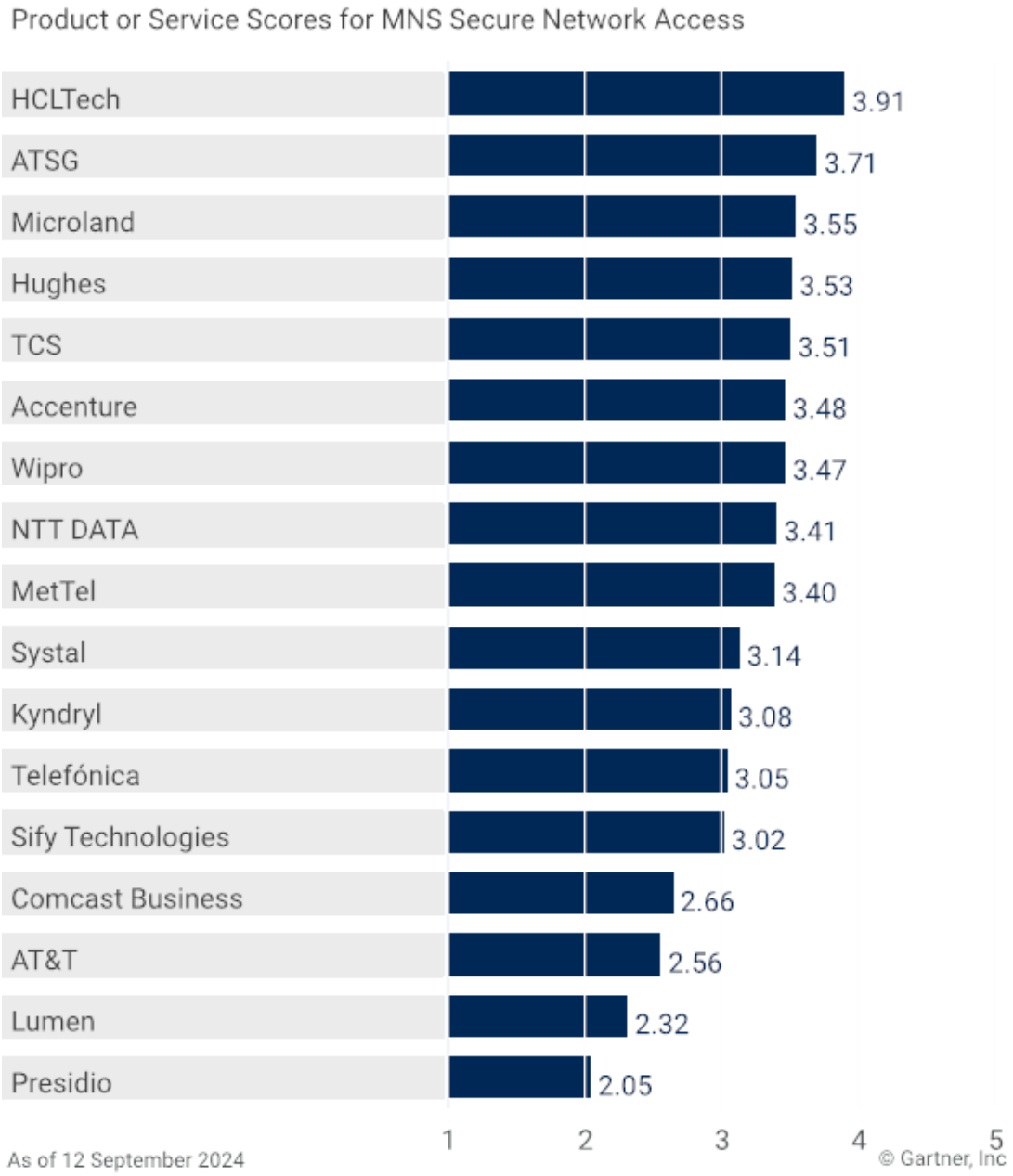
Vendors' Product Scores for MNS Secure Network Access Use Case



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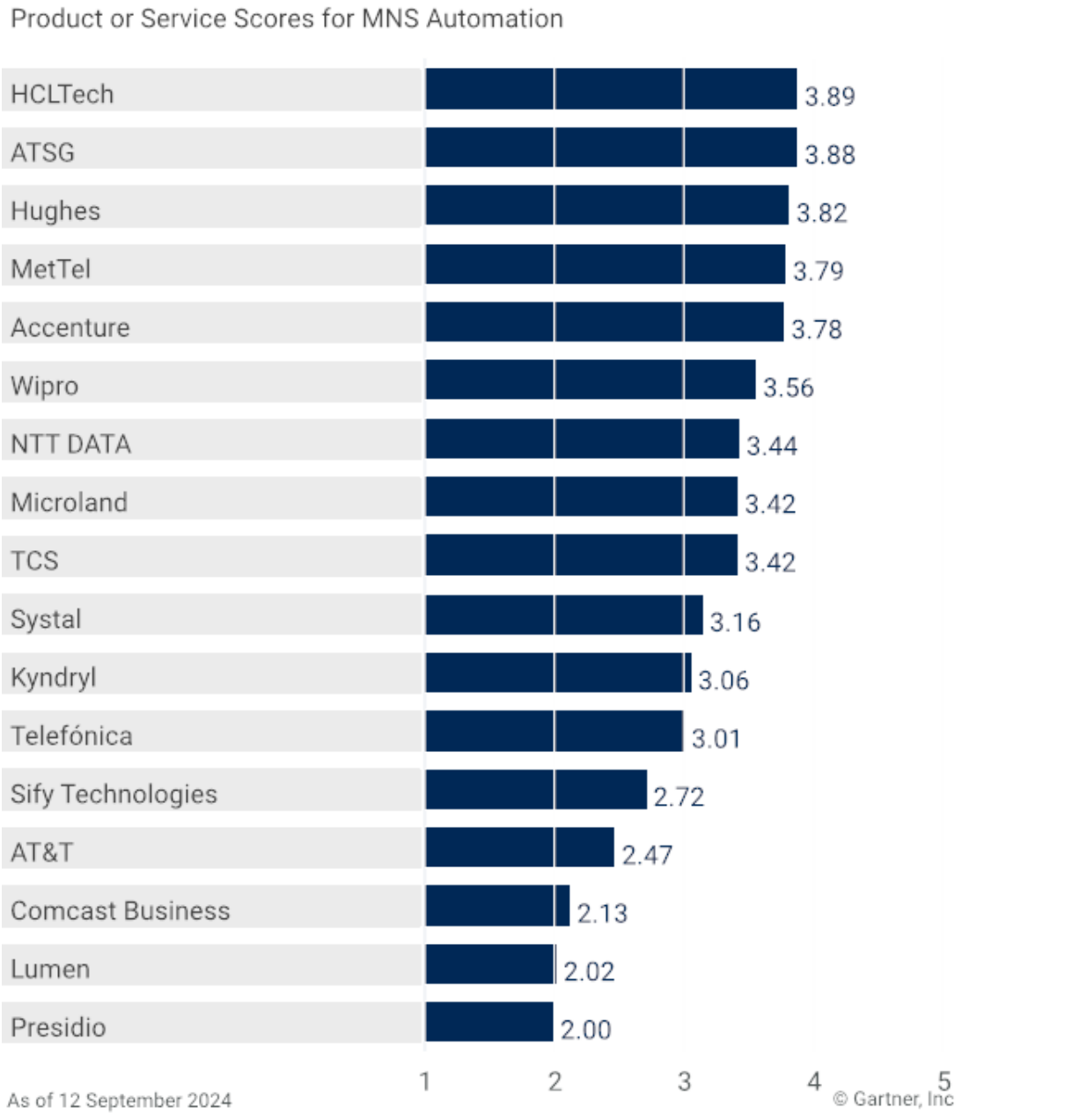
Vendors' Product Scores for MNS Automation Use Case



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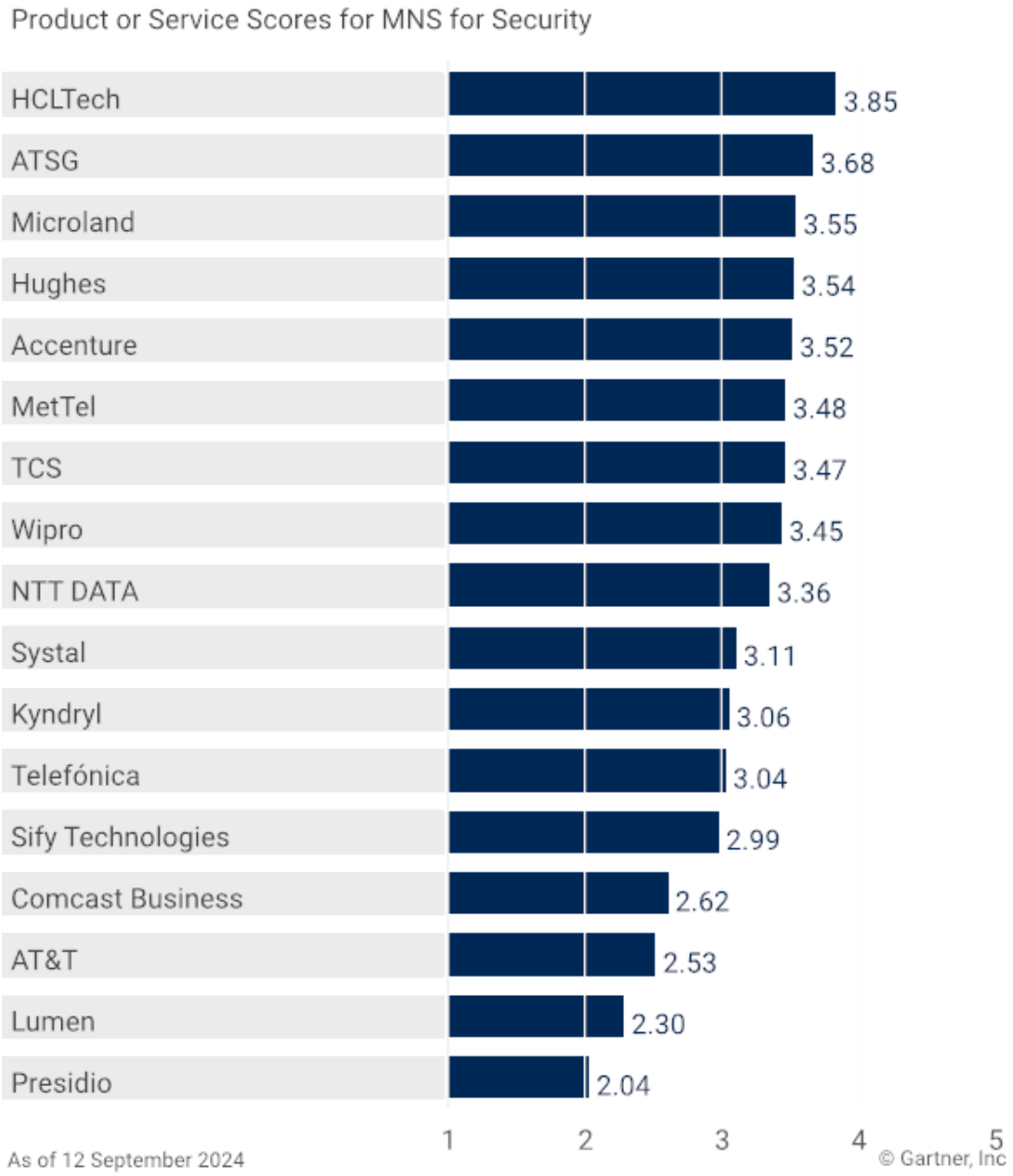
Vendors' Product Scores for MNS for Security Use Case



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Vendors

Accenture

Accenture is headquartered in Dublin, Ireland. Gartner estimates that, worldwide, it manages more than 13,000 LAN and WAN customer sites, as well as about 75 managed security service customers primarily in the Americas and Europe. Key target verticals include manufacturing, transportation and public sector/defense.

Accenture's portfolio of cloud-based MNS services is among the more automation-driven, resulting in a high rate of zero-touch first contact resolution (FCR) and overall FCR.

Although it offers traditional MNS service models, Accenture's main offering is Network as a Service (NaaS). Managed LAN offers include vendor options Juniper Mist, Cisco Meraki, Fortinet and Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) Aruba Networking. Accenture's managed WAN portfolio includes SD-WAN with vendor partners Cisco Catalyst/Meraki Broadcom (VMware), Palo Alto Prisma, Fortinet and Juniper Mist.

Its managed security portfolio ranges from firewall and secure web gateway (SWG) products to security information and event management (SIEM) and security orchestration, automation and response (SOAR). Managed secure access service edge (SASE) offerings are via vendor partners Palo Alto Networks, Zscaler, Cisco, Fortinet, Juniper Mist, HPE-Aruba, Cloudflare and Netskope.

Recent upgrades include integration with Juniper Mist and Cisco Catalyst/Meraki to strengthen managed software-defined branch services. The vendor also has expanded cloud-WAN and virtual-WAN support for cloud-native network services and applied generative AI (GenAI) technology to its managed firewall service to analyze data to detect new security threats and recommend responses.

Accenture scored strongly for managed WAN; above average for overall MNS, secure network access automation and security use cases, and average for the LAN management use case. Accenture is well-suited for managed network services across all geographies.

ATSG

ATSG is based in New York City. Gartner estimates it manages more than 14,000 LAN and WAN customer sites and about 200 firewall customers. Most of its managed network services customers are in the Americas. ATSG focuses on retail and hospitality, healthcare, financial services, manufacturing and media/communications verticals.

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Its MNS architecture and life cycle management support processes are mature, with strong incident identification and resolution processes. ATSG has automated ITSM, device discovery and trouble ticketing tasks to speed response times, and its OPTX AIOps observability platform has been integrated into its service delivery platform. As a result, the vendor has above-average zero-touch first-contact resolution (FCR). Its overall FCR is average.

ATSG Managed LAN services support vendor partners Cisco and HPE Aruba Networking. Its managed WAN services support SD-WAN vendor partners Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, HPE Aruba Networking EdgeConnect SD-WAN and Broadcom (VMware). Security offerings include vendor options Cisco, Palo Alto Networks, Juniper and Fortinet, with SASE options via Cisco, Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet and Zscaler.

ATSG recently expanded its OPTX Platform with AIOps automation to provide better API interfaces for network vendors and reduce human intervention. It also upgraded its OPTX synthetic transaction processing module to measure end-user experience and integrated its Cisco ISE and FortiNac NAC products with zero-trust network access (ZTNA) and VPN.

ATSG scores strongly across all MNS use cases. Enterprises in North America should strongly consider ATSG for its managed network services capabilities.

AT&T

AT&T is based in Dallas, Texas. Gartner estimates that it manages more than 400,000 LAN and WAN customer sites worldwide. It also has about 1,900 managed firewall customers, mostly in the Americas. It targets large enterprises globally as well as U.S. federal, state and local governments, healthcare, SMB and midmarket customers.

AT&T's service assurance platform uses automation for incident detection and response, but it lags behind others in overall automation and AI implementation. Its customer portal offers basic network visibility, billing and incident response information, but it includes redirects to separate service portals and its applications performance analytics is limited. Its first contact resolution scores above average, but its zero-touch FCR scores below average.

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AT&T offers AT&T Business Wi-Fi based on Cisco Meraki or HPE Aruba Networking products and AT&T Managed LAN with vendor partners Cisco, Juniper Networks and HPE Aruba Networking. Managed WAN offerings include SD-WAN vendor options Broadcom (VMware), Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, HPE Aruba EdgeConnect SD-WAN, Palo Alto Networks and Fortinet. For managed SASE, AT&T supports Palo Alto Networks, Zscaler, Fortinet, VMware and Cisco Catalyst/Meraki vendor options.

Recent upgrades include launch of Cisco Meraki SD-WAN for midsize enterprise and a new performance monitoring and alerting service for Cisco Catalyst, Aruba EdgeConnect and Broadcom (VMware) SD-WAN offerings. AT&T also has strengthened integration between its managed network security services and detection and response services.

AT&T scores in the lower quartile across all MNS use cases. Its geographic reach is broad, so it is a suitable option for enterprises with a large global footprint that are seeking a single provider.

Comcast Business

Comcast Business is headquartered in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania. Gartner estimates that it manages more than 265,000 LAN and 128,000 WAN customer sites, plus more than 91,000 managed firewall customers. Most of its managed network services customers are in the United States. Key verticals include retail, financial services, hospitality, manufacturing and the public sector.

Its service delivery platform incorporates AIOps and automation for data collection and portions of service management, but its automation tools and use of AI technology are not as robust as others in this research. Its first contact resolution rate is average and its zero-touch FCR rate is below average.

Comcast Business offers Managed WiFi across several vendors. Its managed SD-WAN offers Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Fortinet, Versa and HPE Aruba EdgeConnect SD-WAN vendor options. Comcast offers its managed SASE service via partner Fortinet.

Recent MNS service upgrades include orchestration improvements for its SD-WAN, LAN and security offering to support holistic control, management and visibility. It also launched a midsize enterprise bundle that pairs managed Fortinet SASE with managed SOC services and added AI technology to enhance firewall traffic monitoring.

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Comcast Business has automated parts of its service delivery, service assurance, data inventory and analytics, but its use of automation to support service operations lags others in this research.

Comcast Business scores in the lower quartile across all MNS use cases. Midsize and primarily U.S.-centric enterprise customers can consider Comcast Business MNS services.

HCLTech

HCLTech is headquartered in Noida, India. Gartner estimates that it manages approximately 163,700 LAN and 145,000 WAN customer sites, and it manages about 400 firewall customers. Most of its customer sites are in the Americas and Europe. HCL primarily targets the healthcare, financial, retail and manufacturing verticals.

HCLTech's service delivery platform is highly automated across provisioning, activation, monitoring, event management and analytics reporting functions. It also incorporates an array of vendor tools for device monitoring, predictive analytics and service management. HCLTech has integrated AI and GenAI into its portal, offering greater network visibility and applications and security status. Despite these automation levels, HCLTech's first contact response and zero-touch FCR rates are average compared to others in this research.

HCLTech's Managed LAN offering is based primarily on Cisco infrastructure products. Its managed WAN portfolio includes SD-WAN vendor options Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, HPE Aruba EdgeConnect SD-WAN, Fortinet, Broadcom (VMware) and Versa. SASE offerings include PaloAlto Networks, Fortinet and Zscaler vendor options.

Notable upgrades include shifting to a NetDevOps operating model to more efficiently deploy, integrate and manage SD-WAN services. The vendor also expanded automation to include predictive analytics for proactive threat mitigation, vulnerability scanning and remediation. It also added configuration management for rapid deployment and updates. It has created GenAI labs to develop processes such as troubleshooting, root cause analysis, and demand forecasting for WAN and SD-WAN services.

HCLTech scores strongly across all MNS use cases. It is a strong choice for all enterprises seeking MNS services across all geographies.

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Hughes

Hughes is headquartered in Germantown, Maryland. Gartner estimates that it manages more than 40,000 LAN and 527,000 WAN customer sites. It also manages about 2,700 firewall customers. Hughes focuses on geographically dispersed enterprises in retail, government and defense verticals, plus energy and agricultural customers with hard-to-serve locations.

Its HughesON service delivery platform governs WAN and LAN support operations using homegrown and third-party asset management, reporting, network analysis, fault and performance management and billing tools. Thanks to significant automation of its service response processes, Hughes' FCR rate and its zero-touch FCR rate is above average compared to other providers in this research. The customer-facing HughesON Portal has been upgraded with Hughes Pulse, a visibility component originally built for internal support agents that offers greater WAN and LAN device detail.

Its managed LAN service supports vendors including Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Fortinet and HPE Aruba Networking. Hughes' WAN services offer wireless solutions that include Ericsson Enterprise (Cradlepoint). For SD-WAN, it offers vendor options Cisco Meraki, Broadcom (VMware) and Fortinet.

Hughes recently expanded its Active Power Edge power management products to the U.K. and European Union markets. It also has added network access control (NAC) capabilities to its SD-LAN and SD-WAN services.

Hughes scores in the upper quartile for overall MNS, LAN management, secure network access, automation and security use cases. It scores above average for the WAN management use case. Hughes should be strongly considered for managed network services in all geographies, particularly in the Americas.

Kyndryl

Kyndryl is based in New York City. Gartner estimates it manages approximately 29,000 LAN and almost 19,800 WAN sites, as well as about 1,600 managed firewall customers. Kyndryl focuses on midsize to large enterprise customers, primarily in the financial services, industrial, retail, energy and healthcare verticals.

Its service delivery platform features provisioning, monitoring, event, service and patch upgrade management using a variety of third-party tools, and it has applied automation to tasks such as device and network configuration, incident detection and response and service requests. However, Kyndryl's FCR and zero-touch FCR are below average.

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While Kyndryl's LAN services include multiple vendor options, its HPE Aruba Networking offering is particularly strong thanks to integration with the Aruba Central management console. WAN services include Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Fortinet, Palo Alto Networks, Broadcom (VMware) and Juniper SD-WAN vendor options. Its managed security services include SASE offerings through vendor partners Cisco and Fortinet.

Recent service improvements include the launch of a private wireless and enterprise campus network service based on wired and Wi-Fi 6E. Kyndryl also launched Security Operations as a Platform (SOaaP), which offers a package of SOAR, SIEM, EDR and VMS technologies with unified management and automated playbooks to reduce incident response times.

Kyndryl scores below average across all use cases. Kyndryl is suitable for managed network services across all geographies.

Lumen

Lumen is headquartered in Monroe, Louisiana. Gartner estimates that it manages more than 27,000 LAN and 255,000 WAN customer sites, and more than 28,000 managed firewall customers. A majority of Lumen's MNS customer base is in the Americas. Lumen's vertical focus includes retail, manufacturing, financial services, healthcare and the public sector (federal/state and local government).

Lumen's managed network service delivery platform includes network inventory, provisioning and activation, service management and digital experience processes, relying on a diverse array of vendor tools. Its automation tooling includes AIOps for monitoring, event correlation, test management and applications monitoring. However, in overall automation and use of AI technology Lumen lags others in this research. Its first contact resolution is above average, but its zero-touch FCR is below average among competitors in this research.

Lumen's managed LAN services are with vendor partners including Cisco Catalyst/Meraki and Juniper Mist. Its managed WAN services include SD-WAN with Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Versa, HPE Aruba EdgeConnect SD-WAN and Fortinet. Its managed SASE offering includes vendor options Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, Versa and HPE Aruba Networking.

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Lumen has added intelligent event correlation for WAN and LAN, using various automation technologies such as IBM WatsonX and Itential. It launched Lumen Defender, a bundle feature for MNS and LAN offerings that adds threat intelligence from its Black Lotus Labs.

Lumen scores in the lower quartile across all MNS use cases. It is best suited for North-America-centric enterprises seeking MNS services.

MetTel

MetTel is based in New York City. Gartner estimates that it manages about 170 LAN and 96,000 WAN customer sites. It also has about 290 managed firewall customers. Most of its customer base is in the Americas. It focuses on verticals including government, healthcare, financial, retail and industrial.

MetTel owns its own WAN backbone, unlike all other competitors in this research. Its service delivery platform for LAN and WAN spans proactive monitoring, network configuration and support, patching, firmware updates and on-site installation. MetTel also uses Intelligent Process Automation to speed service issues diagnosis and has automated some issue resolution processes, such as device reboots. With these automation investments, MetTel's zero-touch FCR rate and overall FCR is above average among competitors in this research.

MetTel offers managed Wi-Fi via vendor partners, including Cisco. Managed SD-WAN vendors include VMware, Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Adtran, Fortinet and Cradlepoint. For managed SASE, MetTel supports Fortinet, VMware and Cisco.

Recent upgrades include a remote managed power distribution unit (PDU) that allows remote WAN and LAN device power reboots via the IPA engine, which can eliminate truck rolls. MetTel also launched a managed MetTel Mobile Core to support wireless "device as a service" offerings, including fleet and other IoT-based products.

MetTel scores strongly for the overall MNS, WAN management and automation use cases, and above average for the security and LAN management use cases. It scores average for the secure network access management use case. Enterprises with global MNS needs should consider MetTel, particularly those in the United States.

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Microland

Microland is based in Bengaluru, India. Gartner estimates it manages about 13,000 LAN and 12,000 WAN enterprise sites, and less than 20 managed firewall customers. Its customer base is concentrated more in the Americas and Europe than in APAC.

Microland's target customer verticals include manufacturing, energy and utilities, government, healthcare, retail and financial enterprise customers.

Its Intelligeni NetOps service delivery platform is highly automated and uses AI to support configuration, automated network and incident management, observability and monitoring, and infrastructure and user experience management, all via a range of vendor tools. These processes are cross-integrated with Microland's customer portal, which supplies a real-time view of customers' network and infrastructure inventory, applications, trouble tickets and incident response. Despite its automation levels, Microland's first contact resolution rate is average, and its zero-touch FCR rate is below average.

Microland's MNS LAN offering supports vendors, including Cisco Catalyst/Meraki and Juniper Mist. Its MNS for WAN services support Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Fortinet, Juniper, Versa and Broadcom (VMware), with traditional and NaaS purchasing options. Its SASE options include vendor options Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Zscaler, Fortinet and Palo Alto Networks.

Recent service upgrades include a deeper integration partnership with Juniper Mist to add new automation use cases for LAN, WAN and security. It also added new automation modules for Day 0 design and Day 2 monitoring and remediation services.

Microland scores strongly for the LAN management, secure network access and security use cases, and above average across all other use cases. All enterprises should strongly consider Microland for all MNS use cases.

NTT DATA

NTT DATA is headquartered in Tokyo, Japan. Gartner estimates NTT DATA manages about 120,000 LAN and 1.5 million WAN customer sites, and 12,000 security sites globally. Its largest customer base is in APAC, followed by the Americas and EMEA. Target verticals include financial services, manufacturing and healthcare.

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NTT DATA's SPEKTRA service delivery platform has incorporated AIOps and automation for incident and service request management while unifying monitoring and access control across service categories. It also uses AI analytics to streamline incident response and repair. As a result, the vendor has one of the highest FCR and zero-touch FCR rates in this research. Network status, incident and usage data from these processes also feeds into the SPEKTRA customer portal.

NTT DATA managed LAN services offer vendor options including Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, HPE Aruba Central and Juniper Mist. Its managed WAN services include SD-WAN options with vendors Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, HPE Aruba EdgeConnect SD-WAN, Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet and Juniper. Managed SASE offerings support vendor options Palo Alto Networks, Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Fortinet, Versa, Broadcom (VMware), Zscaler and Netskope.

Notable service upgrades include expanding its LAN support list to more than 25 vendors and widening its WAN device support to include new appliances from vendors Fortinet, Palo Alto Networks, Checkpoint and Juniper. It also has integrated its platform with Zscaler SASE cloud platform.

NTT DATA scores average for the LAN management use case and average across all other use cases. Enterprises of all sizes — and particularly those in APAC — should consider NTT DATA for all MNS use cases.

Presidio

Presidio is based in New York City. Gartner estimates it manages almost 8,000 LAN and 4,900 WAN customer sites, as well as about 160 firewall customers. A majority of its customer base is in the Americas. Presidio targets the healthcare, finance, media/entertainment and retail verticals.

Presidio's service delivery platform is based on the traditional information technology infrastructure library (ITIL) framework, supporting data collection, monitoring and notification processes via a service desk. This feeds into customer portals that offer customers real-time network performance data, reports and availability metrics for specific services.

Automation such as deduplication and auto-resolution has been incorporated into monitoring and alerts as well as incident management, but Presidio's service delivery is still less automated than competitors. Its first call resolution rate is above average, but its zero-touch FCR is below average.

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Presidio's LAN services offer Cisco Catalyst/Meraki and HPE Aruba Networking and Arista vendor options. Its managed WAN services include support for SD-WAN vendors Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Fortinet, Palo Alto Networks and HPE Aruba EdgeConnect SD-WAN. It also offers managed SASE via partners including Cisco Meraki and Palo Alto Networks.

Recent upgrades include adding digital customer experience features to its managed LAN service and expanding integration with vendors including Juniper and Arista. It also has invested in training for its support personnel across LAN, WAN and security service operations.

Presidio scores in the lowest quartile across all MNS use cases. Its services align best with midsize enterprises, particularly those with networking needs in North America.

Sify Technologies

Sify Technologies (Sify) is based in Chennai, India. Gartner estimates that it manages about 54,000 LAN and 75,000 WAN customer sites, and about 200 managed firewall customers. The vendor can deliver services globally, but all of its current customers are in APAC. It primarily targets the financial services vertical.

Sify's service delivery platform incorporates automation across service qualification, installation and provisioning, and to a lesser extent, monitoring, incident and change management and billing processes. Its Aakaash customer portal has recently been upgraded to offer greater network status, trouble ticket, applications usage and analytics information. However, it offers more limited user applications experience and ability to integrate with customer ITSM systems. Sify's first contact resolution and zero-touch FCR rates are below average for this competitive set.

Sify's managed LAN services include support for Cisco Meraki and Fortinet vendor options. Its managed WAN services include support for SD-WAN vendors, including Cisco Catalyst, Fortinet, Versa, HPE EdgeConnect SD-WAN and FatPipe Networks. Sify also offers managed SASE with Netskope and Zscaler vendor options.

Sify has made several recent MNS upgrades, including the addition of Zero Trust Network Access support. It also has launched Branch-in-a-Box, a preconfigured small-office package that includes a WAN router and network switch, LAN access points, bundled connectivity and security including unified threat management, monitoring and cloud-based management control.

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Sify scores below average across all MNS use cases. It is best aligned to customers with MNS needs in APAC.

Systal

Systal is headquartered in Glasgow, U.K. Gartner estimates it manages about 3,500 LAN and 634 WAN customer sites, as well as about 110 managed firewall customers. Most of its customer sites are in Europe. Systal has a concentration of customers in verticals including utilities, manufacturing and financial services.

Systal's service delivery platform features above-average integration with its key vendor partner systems. It has integrated automation for certain workflows, but its API integration with key ITSM tools including ServiceNow is still somewhat limited. As a result, its FCR rate is above average, but its zero-touch FCR is below average. Systal's customer portal is more basic in its network visibility and analytics features and lags others in this research.

Systal's managed LAN service includes Cisco Catalyst/Meraki and Juniper vendor options. For managed WAN services, it offers SD-WAN vendor options including Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Fortinet, Cato Networks, Palo Alto Networks and Juniper. Managed SASE vendor options include Palo Alto Networks, Cato Networks, Fortinet, Zscaler and Cisco.

Recent service upgrades include incremental customer portal upgrades that added real-time network status and the ability to submit a simple form for change requests. Systal also aligned its NOC and SOC functions to provide a more comprehensive view of customer environments and added automated customer notification when a trouble ticket is generated.

Systal scores below average across all use cases. It is best suited for MNS customers with service needs in Europe.

TCS

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) is based in Mumbai, India. Gartner estimates it manages more than 35,000 LAN and 34,000 WAN customer sites. It also maintains firewalls for about 200 customers. Unlike many others in this research, it does not focus on specific customer verticals.

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TCS Cognix for Networks service delivery platform features automated AIOps processes for event management, service mapping and predictive analysis processes. It employs machine learning AI to support asset, user experience, service assurance and service delivery management. The integrated TCS Cognix for Networks customer portal displays network status, hardware inventory, service incidents and ticketing, security incidents and ability to customize portal views. TCS's first contact resolution and zero-touch FCR rates are above average among competitors in this research.

Managed LAN services include support for Cisco Catalyst/Meraki and Fortinet. For managed WAN, TCS supports SD-WAN vendors Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, HPE EdgeConnect SD-WAN, Versa, Fortinet and Palo Alto Networks. Managed SASE options include vendors Versa, Fortinet, Palo Alto Networks, Zscaler and Netskope.

Recent upgrades include a private 5G development offering with partners including Cisco, Ericsson, HPE and others. The vendor also has integrated Cisco Catalyst and Versa SD-WAN into its TCS Cognix for Networks platform, and it launched a bundled, integrated offering that includes managed firewall, security service edge (SSE) and IT/OT features.

TCS scores strongly for the secure network access use case, above average for the security use case and average for all other use cases. It scores average for automation. TCS should be considered for all enterprises that are seeking MNS services across all regions.

Telefónica

Telefónica is headquartered in Madrid, Spain. Gartner estimates that it manages more than 328,000 LAN and 524,000 WAN sites, and it manages firewalls for about 500 customers. It has an extensive global service footprint and targets a range of verticals, but has focused recently specifically on key verticals such as hospitality.

Telefónica's Global LAN service delivery platform incorporates multiple tools to support orchestration, order, inventory management and billing processes, and it has numerous API integrations with vendor partners. Telefónica maps these service processes to its Customer Control Center portal, which provides network visibility, performance, incident ticketing and network analytics. The vendor has expanded use of automation for service delivery, but it still lags others in this research. Its FCR and zero-touch FCR rates are below average compared to other providers in this research.

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Telefónica's managed LAN offerings include Cisco Meraki, Fortinet and HPE Aruba Networking vendor options. Its managed WAN portfolio includes SD-WAN with vendor options Cisco Catalyst/Viptela, Fortinet, HPE Aruba Networking EdgeConnect SD-WAN and Nokia Nuage. Its SASE portfolio includes Cisco Catalyst, Fortinet, Palo Alto Networks, Netskope and Zscaler vendor options.

Notable managed network service upgrades include the launch of SD-WAN offerings for midsize enterprises, with Fortinet and Cisco Meraki vendor options. Telefónica enhanced LAN access point and switch monitoring capabilities and added WAN security monitoring upgrades to allow proactive alerts.

Telefónica scores below average across all use cases. Enterprises should consider Telefónica for MNS services concentrated in North America and Europe.

Wipro

Wipro is based in Bengaluru, India. Gartner estimates that it manages more than 53,000 LAN and 40,000 WAN customer sites, and manages firewall service to about 200 customers. It has a wide marketing focus, with key verticals including financial, energy and utilities, public sector and retail.

Wipro's HOLMES service delivery platform has automated workflows across monitoring, event management, network health reporting, service requests, provisioning and incident resolution. Through API integrations, Holmes incorporates various ITSM, reporting monitoring and management tools, and it has added AI technology to enhance its security monitoring services. Despite significant service automation, its service response results are mixed, with above-average FCR but below-average zero-touch FCR.

A majority of Wipro's managed WAN service contracts also include managed LAN support, with vendor options including Cisco, HPE Aruba Networking, Palo Alto Networks and Juniper. Its managed SD-WAN vendor partners include Cisco Catalyst/Meraki, Palo Alto Networks, HPE Aruba EdgeConnect SD-WAN and Broadcom (VMware). Wipro's managed SASE portfolio includes Palo Alto Networks, Cisco Netskope and Zscaler vendor options.

Recent service enhancements include adding GenAI technology to its service platform and tool additions to upgrade its co-managed network services. Wipro also invested in automation and orchestration upgrades for incident response and added automated threat intelligence integration to detect and prevent threats.

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Wipro scores average in security and above average across all other use cases. Enterprises in all geographies should consider Wipro for all MNS capabilities.

Context

Enterprise networking is becoming increasingly complex to accommodate a variety of users, devices, critical applications and locations. In response, many enterprises are turning to third-party managed network and security services to offset lack of in-house skills, improve cost-efficiency and ensure stable, better-performing IT environments.

Based on Gartner research and MNS customer feedback, managed LAN, WAN and security services vary in capabilities and service availability. Among the key capabilities featured in this critical capabilities research are strength of the provider's service delivery platform and service-level agreements, ability to serve a wide geographic footprint and quality of customer service portals. An area of increasing differentiation is service providers' use of automation and AI technology to increase efficiency of service activation, configuration and incident response.

Market Definition

The managed network services (MNS) market focuses on externally provided, network operations center (NOC) functionality, as well as relevant network and security life cycle services that deliver current and emerging requirements to end users.

Gartner defines the MNS market as globally capable providers of remote service management functions for the network and security operations of enterprise networks, including:

- **Managed LAN services (MNS for LAN)** must include the management of enterprise LAN customer premises equipment (CPE), such as campus switches and wireless access points. It provides single point of contact (SPOC) ownership for the life cycle management of these devices. These services may include the management of customer Internet of Things/Industrial IoT (IoT/IIoT) infrastructure and endpoints. These services may include managed operations services for other elements, such on-premises servers, storage, gateways and controllers.

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- **Managed WAN services (MNS for WAN)** must include the management of site edge ingress and egress CPE, and any WAN connections and service operations management. These services provide life cycle management for site edge CPE, such as routers, firewalls and software defined WAN (SD-WAN), with or without security co-residency on site edge CPE. The services must include a SPOC, ownership for the life cycle management of these devices for site edge CPE, and transport services connecting client sites to any destination. This includes hybrid cloud or other non-client-owned locations. These services may also include the operations management of enterprise customer IoT/IIoT infrastructure and endpoint management.

- **Managed security (MNS for security) functions** include health, configuration and maintenance support for security technologies. Service delivery is for a single vendor to enterprise clients of multiple vendors of converged network and security function life cycle management operations. These include the support of: (1) SD-WAN-embedded security functions; (2) secure web gateways (SWGs); (3) cloud access security brokers (CASBs); (4) network access control (NAC); and (5) network firewalling, with or without intrusion prevention system/intrusion detection system (IPS/IDS). MNS for Security supports branch offices, remote workers and on-premises general internet security, private application access, and cloud service security functions for consumption use cases.

Mandatory Features

The mandatory features for this market include:

- **Service delivery platform (SDP):** This area is specific to the application tool infrastructure and the integration of the MNS provider's SDP. An MNS provider's SDP involves the integrated application architecture and the enabling technologies designed to support the standardized, high-quality and scalable delivery of managed network services to enterprise customers. The single MNS SDP supporting LAN and WAN may be separate from, but will be integrated with, a security-specific MNS SDP.

- **Service management:** MNS management refers to the entirety of life cycle activities — supported by tool-based workflows, automation and customer support mechanisms that are performed by MNS providers. MNS providers deliver these services with internal employee resources for all enterprise customers and industry segments.

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- **Operations automation:** This includes the automation of tasks and activities related to the SDP, service management functions, and customer experience (CX) management to achieve consistent MNS service delivery quality.

Note: The MNS market does not include any network or security products, software, maintenance, network services, or cloud-based services or products. These elements are covered by other Gartner research.

Common Features

The common features for this market include:

- Support for customer endpoints beyond network and security that may include physical/virtual servers, storage, power, environmental systems, physical security, operational technology (OT) and IIOT.
- Formal continual service improvement programs for MNS customers.
- Networking and security architecture design services.
- Certifications, such as ITIL v3/v4, relevant OEM vendor and System and Organization Controls (SOC) 2 certifications.
- Network and security product resale or as OEM sale offers.

Product/Service Class Definition

Providers covered in this research offer managed network services to enterprise organizations. These service management functions for the operation of enterprise networks are specific to LAN, WAN and security. Gartner has observed differentiation resulting from a number of factors, including additional network policy enhancements, better security alignment, increased responsiveness, and improved visibility into and management of network infrastructure.

MNS market trends vary by segment. Gartner projects the market for traditional managed WAN services will decline with a 6.2% compound annual growth rate (CAGR) through 2027. Meanwhile, managed SD-WAN services will grow by a 14.4% CAGR for that period. Managed LAN/WLAN services spending is projected to grow a modest 2.2% CAGR through this time period.

Based on market research and more than 800 inquiry calls during this research period, Gartner sees several trends shaping the managed network services market:

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- **Managed SD-WAN.** Gartner estimates that 70% of SD-WAN buyers on a worldwide basis use managed network services. Also, for enterprise clients, sourcing managed network services for WAN, security and potentially LAN from one service provider instead of several lowers the risks associated with fragmented operations flows (see Market Opportunity Map: Enterprise Network Services, Worldwide).

- **Security focus.** Network security is an increased focus for enterprise customers, and that is driving interest in managed security, including SSE and SASE. Gartner expects that, over the next five years, the market for SASE will grow at a CAGR of 29%, reaching over $25 billion by 2027 (see Forecast Analysis: Secure Access Service Edge, Worldwide).

- **Automation and AI.** Automation and AI are playing a larger role in network and security monitoring across MNS providers, including services offered by communications service providers (CSPs). Gartner predicts that, by 2028, automation, augmented intelligence and delayering will make 70% of current CSP workforce technical skills obsolete.

- **Flat to downward pricing.** Based on client proposal reviews, Gartner has observed downward MNS pricing, particularly for LAN services. Prices for MNS WAN services also continue to decline, mirroring pricing trends seen in the related network services market.

Critical Capabilities Definition

Service Delivery Platform

The service delivery platform (SDP) includes the application tool infrastructure and integrations supporting service delivery of the provider's MNS offerings. An MNS provider's SDP is designed to allow standardized, high-quality and scalable delivery of MNS to enterprise customers.

Service Management Functions

Service management functions refers to the end-to-end functional processes supported by tool-based workflows, automation and customer support mechanisms from MNS providers. The service management functions typically align with the ITIL framework.

Operations Automation

Operations automation includes automating tasks and activities related to service delivery, service management and customer experience management in order to achieve consistent MNS delivery quality.

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Operations automation for MNS is the key to the efficiency and quality of the service delivery platform at scale. Automation is critical to maintaining service delivery quality and positive customer experience from provider MNS offerings.

Customer Experience Management

Customer service portals comprise all customer support management functions and business impact reporting, such as customer portal functions, customer management, service requests, network performance, case management, customer co-management, and provider and network operations performance.

High-quality MNS customer experience is possible when supported by the appropriate SDP with heavy automation and fast response times.

LAN Management

MNS for LAN includes a single point of contact for the management of all in-scope LAN CPE OEMs. MNS for LAN offered by the providers covers all common LAN components, including switches and access points.

Beyond these core components, almost any LAN-connected IP networking device can be monitored and maintained by many MNS providers.

WAN Management

MNS for WAN includes the management of all in-scope site edge networking customer premises equipment (CPE). It includes managed router and managed SD-WAN services, as well as management of all WAN transport services connecting these sites (e.g., a single point of contact [SPOC]).

Multiple technology combinations are possible on the same platform for routing, SD-WAN and firewalls where provider-developed and integrated appliance or universal (virtual) customer premises equipment (uCPE)-based platforms are supported. Some providers offer co-management options.

Security Management

MNS for security supports branch-office, remote-worker and on-premises general internet security. This includes support for SD-WAN embedded security functions, SWG, cloud access security broker (CASB), network access control (NAC) and network firewalling.

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Use Cases

MNS Overall Competency

This use case is a measurement of overall provider competency in delivering comprehensive managed network services, including MNS for LAN, WAN and security.

This use case focuses on the management and service quality attributes related to MNS, and includes all weighted scores associated with the five management elements.

MNS for LAN

This use case focuses on the management and service support of the LAN environment. The scoring and weighting are primarily for the actual managed network services for LAN.

They also include the service elements that can be customized to the enterprise requirements. This use case typically includes a SPOC for the management of all in-scope LAN CPE OEMs.

MNS for WAN

This use case focuses on the WAN management and service support environment, including a SPOC for the management of all in-scope WAN CPE OEMs and network transport circuits.

The scoring and weighting focus on actual managed network services for WAN, but also include the service elements that can be configured to the enterprise requirements.

MNS Secure Network Access

This use case focuses on end-user network access to enterprise application resources. This includes policies on a network for controlling access by devices and users.

Policies may be based on device and/or user authentication and the status of endpoint configuration.

MNS Automation

This use case focuses on automation performance, service delivery cycle times and key service-level quality activities.

This includes first contact resolution for incidents, network source of truth maintenance and portal reporting.

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MNS for Security

This use case focuses on overall in-scope managed security functions. This includes elements of MNS for security life cycle activities and key performance metrics.

While this use case predominantly focuses on the managed security features, it also includes the service elements that support unique security concerns and requirements.

Providers Added and Dropped

Added

- Accenture
- Telefónica

Dropped

- BT
- Orange Business

Inclusion Criteria

Providers in this research were required to meet the following criteria:

Service Capabilities

- Provide MNS to enterprises for networking products and related network services on a 24/7 basis for customer locations globally.
- Offer a fixed monthly subscription fee for each device managed for enterprise customers for MNS for LAN, WAN and security offers.
- Provide MNS for network operations life cycle management of networking hardware/software in support of both LAN and WAN technologies, as defined by the MNS market definition.
- Operate a multitenant SDP for MNS customers using exclusively internal employees. Provide services for customers' existing LAN, WAN and security environments (for example, greenfield/brownfield environments and managed takeover), in addition to transformed LAN, WAN and security customer environments, or otherwise adopting updated network and security networking technologies.

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- Confirm service management processes and tools for MNS achieve a minimum average of 80% FCR for all incidents, whether manual or automated. Proof of specific percentage attainment and all underlying method details are required to be demonstrated and provided to demonstrate compliance for inclusion in this research.
- Confirm service management processes and tools for MNS (specifically for MNS for LAN, WAN and security only) achieve a minimum average of 20% first-contact resolution for all incidents via automation (with zero manual touch). Proof of specific percentage attainment and all underlying method details are required to be demonstrated and provided to demonstrate compliance for inclusion in this research.
- Currently offer at least four of the following five categories of security products for MNS for security services including:
  - SD-WAN (with or without embedded security functions)
  - Secure web gateway
  - Cloud access security broker
  - Network access control
  - Network firewalling (with or without IDS/IPS)
- Provide evidence of current and planned security incident automation methods, tools and performance KPIs that are tracked and reported, applicable specifically to MNS for security.

Business/Financial Performance

- Have at least 1,000 MNS for LAN customer sites, at least 1,000 MNS for WAN customer sites, and at least 500 MNS for security customer sites (under active MNS contracts). Specific site-level customer data (for example, quantities of devices) is required to be included in this research (under active MNS contracts). Evidence provided shall include customer locations for MNS for each of LAN, WAN and security on a global basis in at least three of the following regions: North America, Europe, APAC, Middle East/Africa and Latin/South America.

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Table 1: Weighting for Critical Capabilities in Use Cases

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Critical Capabilities	*MNS Overall Competency*	*MNS for LAN*	*MNS for WAN*	*MNS Secure Network Access*	*MNS Automation*	*MNS for Security*
Service Delivery Platform	20%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%
Service Management Functions	15%	15%	15%	10%	10%	15%
Operations Automation	20%	20%	20%	20%	70%	20%
Customer Experience Management	15%	15%	15%	10%	10%	15%
LAN Management	10%	40%	0%	5%	0%	0%
WAN Management	10%	0%	40%	5%	0%	0%
Security Management	10%	0%	0%	40%	0%	40%
As of 12 September 2024						

Source: Gartner (October 2024)

This methodology requires analysts to identify the critical capabilities for a class of products/services. Each capability is then weighted in terms of its relative importance for specific product/service use cases.

Each of the products/services that meet our inclusion criteria has been evaluated on the critical capabilities on a scale from 1.0 to 5.0.

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Critical Capabilities Rating

Table 2: Product/Service Rating on Critical Capabilities

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Critical Capabilities	Accenture	AT&T	ATSG	Comcast Business	HCLTech	Hughes	Kyndryl	Lumen	MetTel	Microland	NTT DATA	Presidio	Sify Technologies	Systal	TCS	Telefónica	Wipro
Service Delivery Platform	3.2	3.5	2.8	2.5	3.7	3.1	2.8	2.3	3.5	3.4	3.8	2.0	2.4	3.8	3.3	2.5	3.9
Service Management Functions	3.5	2.5	3.5	3.1	3.1	3.2	3.3	2.8	3.8	2.9	2.7	2.4	3.4	2.4	2.9	3.2	3.0
Operations Automation	3.9	2.4	4.1	1.9	4.0	4.0	3.1	1.9	3.8	3.4	3.5	2.0	2.6	3.2	3.5	3.0	3.6
Customer Experience Management	3.8	1.9	3.8	2.4	4.1	3.9	2.8	1.8	4.0	4.1	3.4	1.6	3.2	3.0	3.5	3.4	3.5
LAN Management	3.1	2.4	4.0	3.4	4.3	3.6	3.3	2.4	3.0	3.6	3.7	2.0	3.6	3.0	3.6	3.6	3.5
WAN Management	3.5	2.5	3.9	2.9	4.0	3.3	3.3	2.5	3.2	3.4	3.5	2.1	3.5	2.9	3.6	3.1	3.4
Security Management	3.3	2.6	3.7	2.9	4.0	3.4	3.1	2.5	3.0	3.7	3.4	2.1	3.1	3.2	3.7	3.0	3.4
As of 12 September 2024																	

Source: Gartner (October 2024)

Table 3 shows the product/service scores for each use case. The scores, which are generated by multiplying the use-case weightings by the product/service ratings, summarize how well the critical capabilities are met for each use case.

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Table 3: Product Score in Use Cases

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Use Cases	Accenture	AT&T	ATSG	Comcast Business	HCLTech	Hughes	Kyndryl	Lumen	MetTel	Microland	NTT DATA	Presidio	Sify Technologies	Systal	TCS	Telefónica	Wipro
MNS Overall Competency	3.51	2.59	3.64	2.63	3.85	3.52	3.07	2.27	3.55	3.48	3.44	2.02	3.01	3.12	3.41	3.06	3.51
MNS for LAN	3.44	2.45	3.80	2.82	3.97	3.62	3.14	2.26	3.48	3.51	3.48	2.00	3.19	3.03	3.43	3.28	3.49
MNS for WAN	3.60	2.49	3.76	2.62	3.85	3.50	3.14	2.30	3.56	3.43	3.40	2.04	3.15	2.99	3.43	3.08	3.45
MNS Secure Network Access	3.48	2.56	3.71	2.66	3.91	3.53	3.08	2.32	3.40	3.55	3.41	2.05	3.02	3.14	3.51	3.05	3.47
MNS Automation	3.78	2.47	3.88	2.13	3.89	3.82	3.06	2.02	3.79	3.42	3.44	2.00	2.72	3.16	3.42	3.01	3.56
MNS for Security	3.52	2.53	3.68	2.62	3.85	3.54	3.06	2.30	3.48	3.55	3.36	2.04	2.99	3.11	3.47	3.04	3.45
As of 12 September 2024																	

Source: Gartner (October 2024)

To determine an overall score for each product/service in the use cases, multiply the ratings in Table 2 by the weightings shown in Table 1.

Evidence

- Gartner analysts conducted more than 800 inquiry calls related to managed network services between May 1, 2023 and April 30, 2024.
- In 2024, all providers included in this research responded to an extensive questionnaire regarding their current/future MNS offerings, and provided many offer, proposal, market penetration and services artifacts.
- Gartner analysts reviewed all available vendor end-customer Peer Insights for quality purposes. All providers in this research had the opportunity to encourage customer peer reviews. These end-customer insights (Peer Insights) can be found on the Gartner client portal by market name and provider name across numerous covered markets.

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Critical Capabilities Methodology

This methodology requires analysts to identify the critical capabilities for a class of products or services. Each capability is then weighted in terms of its relative importance for specific product or service use cases. Next, products/services are rated in terms of how well they achieve each of the critical capabilities. A score that summarizes how well they meet the critical capabilities for each use case is then calculated for each product/service.

"Critical capabilities" are attributes that differentiate products/services in a class in terms of their quality and performance. Gartner recommends that users consider the set of critical capabilities as some of the most important criteria for acquisition decisions.

In defining the product/service category for evaluation, the analyst first identifies the leading uses for the products/services in this market. What needs are end-users looking to fulfill, when considering products/services in this market? Use cases should match common client deployment scenarios. These distinct client scenarios define the Use Cases.

The analyst then identifies the critical capabilities. These capabilities are generalized groups of features commonly required by this class of products/services. Each capability is assigned a level of importance in fulfilling that particular need; some sets of features are more important than others, depending on the use case being evaluated.

Each vendor's product or service is evaluated in terms of how well it delivers each capability, on a five-point scale. These ratings are displayed side-by-side for all vendors, allowing easy comparisons between the different sets of features.

Ratings and summary scores range from 1.0 to 5.0:

1 = Poor or Absent: most or all defined requirements for a capability are not achieved

2 = Fair: some requirements are not achieved

3 = Good: meets requirements

4 = Excellent: meets or exceeds some requirements

5 = Outstanding: significantly exceeds requirements

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To determine an overall score for each product in the use cases, the product ratings are multiplied by the weightings to come up with the product score in use cases.

The critical capabilities Gartner has selected do not represent all capabilities for any product; therefore, may not represent those most important for a specific use situation or business objective. Clients should use a critical capabilities analysis as one of several sources of input about a product before making a product/service decision.

Document Revision History

Critical Capabilities for Managed Network Services - 13 November 2023

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Critical Capabilities for Managed Network Services - 10 November 2021

Critical Capabilities for Managed Network Services - 10 November 2020

Recommended by the Authors

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How Products and Services Are Evaluated in Gartner Critical Capabilities

Magic Quadrant for Managed Network Services

Case Study: Align Managed Network and Security Services

How Should I Choose a Managed SASE Provider?

Tool: RFP for Managed Network Services

How to Choose Between Managed SASE Services

Innovation Insight: AI Networking Has the Potential to Revolutionize Network Operations

Which Network Operations Model is Right for You?

Quick Answer: What SLAs Should I Require From My MNS Provider?

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LAN Management	10%	40%	0%	5%	0%	0%
WAN Management	10%	0%	40%	5%	0%	0%
Security Management	10%	0%	0%	40%	0%	40%
As of 12 September 2024						

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Table 2: Product/Service Rating on Critical Capabilities

Critical Capabilities	*Accenture*	*AT&T*	*ATSG*	*Comcast Business*	*HCLTech*	*Hughes*	*Kyndryl*	*Lumen*	*MetTel*	*Microland*	*NTT DATA*	*Presidio*	*Sify Technologies*	*Systal*	*TCS*	*Telefónica*	*Wipro*
Service Delivery Platform	3.2	3.5	2.8	2.5	3.7	3.1	2.8	2.3	3.5	3.4	3.8	2.0	2.4	3.8	3.3	2.5	3.9
Service Management Functions	3.5	2.5	3.5	3.1	3.1	3.2	3.3	2.8	3.8	2.9	2.7	2.4	3.4	2.4	2.9	3.2	3.0
Operations Automation	3.9	2.4	4.1	1.9	4.0	4.0	3.1	1.9	3.8	3.4	3.5	2.0	2.6	3.2	3.5	3.0	3.6
Customer Experience Management	3.8	1.9	3.8	2.4	4.1	3.9	2.8	1.8	4.0	4.1	3.4	1.6	3.2	3.0	3.5	3.4	3.5
LAN Management	3.1	2.4	4.0	3.4	4.3	3.6	3.3	2.4	3.0	3.6	3.7	2.0	3.6	3.0	3.6	3.6	3.5

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WAN Management	3.5	2.5	3.9	2.9	4.0	3.3	3.3	2.5	3.2	3.4	3.5	2.1	3.5	2.9	3.6	3.1	3.4
Security Management	3.3	2.6	3.7	2.9	4.0	3.4	3.1	2.5	3.0	3.7	3.4	2.1	3.1	3.2	3.7	3.0	3.4
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Use Cases	*Accenture*	*AT&T*	*ATSG*	*Comcast Business*	*HCLTech*	*Hughes*	*Kyndryl*	*Lumen*	*MetTel*	*Microland*	*NTT DATA*	*Presidio*	*Sify Technologies*	*Systal*	*TCS*	*Telefónica*	*Wipro*
MNS Overall Competency	3.51	2.59	3.64	2.63	3.85	3.52	3.07	2.27	3.55	3.48	3.44	2.02	3.01	3.12	3.41	3.06	3.51
MNS for LAN	3.44	2.45	3.80	2.82	3.97	3.62	3.14	2.26	3.48	3.51	3.48	2.00	3.19	3.03	3.43	3.28	3.49
MNS for WAN	3.60	2.49	3.76	2.62	3.85	3.50	3.14	2.30	3.56	3.43	3.40	2.04	3.15	2.99	3.43	3.08	3.45
MNS Secure Network Access	3.48	2.56	3.71	2.66	3.91	3.53	3.08	2.32	3.40	3.55	3.41	2.05	3.02	3.14	3.51	3.05	3.47
MNS Automation	3.78	2.47	3.88	2.13	3.89	3.82	3.06	2.02	3.79	3.42	3.44	2.00	2.72	3.16	3.42	3.01	3.56
MNS for Security	3.52	2.53	3.68	2.62	3.85	3.54	3.06	2.30	3.48	3.55	3.36	2.04	2.99	3.11	3.47	3.04	3.45
As of 12 September 2024																	

Source: Gartner (October 2024)

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